

Scams • Chapter 4

Pressure tactics, both ways

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 7 minutes to read

Pressure is a set of moves that make a no feel costly. This chapter names them from the side of the person who must recognise and refuse them, whether the move comes from a dom, from a sub or from a design.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- Pressure takes away time, choice or privacy. The moves are few and they repeat.
- Some of these moves are play between adults who chose them. The line is whether you chose, with a cap and a stop you control.
- Words about respect do not mean the pressure has stopped.
- Pressure also lives in games and apps, with no person needed.

- It runs both ways, but not equally: the dom is paid and designs the tools.

You will learn

- How to spot the moves that take away your time, your feelings or your privacy.
- A short counter for each move.
- Which designs in games and apps are pressure.
- What subs do to doms, and how written rules answer it.
- How to refuse once, calmly, and where to go when the spending stops being a game.

Pressure is the part of this game that works best, and it works on anyone. I name each move from the side of the person who receives it, so that it can be refused. Some of these moves are play between adults who chose them. What separates play from pressure is whether you chose, with a cap and a stop that you control.

— **Vivian**

How pressure works

Pressure takes away time, choice or privacy. Nearly every move below does one of the three, and it works best on a person who is aroused, tired, ashamed or attached. A scene built on those states is a scene where they are normal, which is why the same moves work here so well.

Press gives real examples. A former participant describes men who sold cars, took on debt and worked second jobs. ◎ Reported The same reporting says that some dominants blackmailed submissives or targeted people in support groups. ◎ Reported A writer calls the threat of exposure a common punishment from financial doms. ◎ Reported A study notes that some findommes keep humiliation lists of clients who fail to give enough tribute. ✓ Verified

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V **Vivian's field notes**

Humiliation, ownership and rigged bets can be fantasies that adults choose. The same words become pressure when the sub did not choose them, cannot see the cost or has no way to stop. The test I use is whether the performance is steering the spending. A sub who gave in was under pressure built to work, and nothing here is a verdict on him.

◑

The moves, and the counter

Each row says what you may see or hear, then what to do. Some moves are described and some are phrased in typical words; none is quoted from anyone.

Time and choice

What they say or do

1 A deadline of tonight, after which the offer is gone

The counter

Wait an hour, then a day. Never send under a time limit. Real play survives the wait.

What they say or do

2 A two-choice ultimatum with a same-day deadline, where both choices favour the dom

The counter

Refuse the frame. A third answer always exists: reply tomorrow.

What they say or do

3 “You already owe me a round sum.”

The counter

No debt exists unless you agreed to one in advance. You can walk away.

What they say or do

4 “Your cap was cute. Now prove it.”

The counter

The cap is the rule. Say it once, then stop discussing it.

What they say or do

5 Respect for your limits, followed at once by a request just past them

The counter

Take the respect and ignore the next sentence. Words about limits do not mean the nudge has stopped.

Time pressure is the most dangerous when it is repeated by several doms at once, on a sub who is chatting with all of them. In my experience that is how a single evening can empty a month.

Feelings

What they say or do

1 Constant praise and attention, then sudden silence (love bombing)

The counter

Notice the pattern. Never pay to end a silence. Ask what is wanted and slow down.

What they say or do

2 Anger, then disappointment, then conditional forgiveness: “After everything I have done for you.”

The counter

Feelings are not a bill. A healthy bond survives a boundary.

What they say or do

3 Permission given together with visible hurt

The counter

Permission that arrives with hurt is not free. Ask for a plain yes or no and talk about the need underneath.

What they say or do

4 An offer of support, then coldness when you say you are fine

The counter

Warmth that depends on compliance teaches that independence costs affection. Keep warmth that does not.

What they say or do

5 A show of how easily you could be controlled, followed by a promise not to use that power

The counter

The power exists whether or not it is used. Notice it.

Keys, isolation and money timing

What they say or do

1 A demand for your login, a code or a remote session as proof of honesty

The counter

Keys to your identity are not proof. Refuse, and offer nothing from your accounts. See Case files. ◑

What they say or do

2 Questions that treat your wish for privacy as suspicious

The counter

Say the boundary once, calmly. A wish for privacy needs no proof. ◑

What they say or do

3 Requests to bring your doubts to one dom only, to ask her before you contact another dom, or to tell others you are busy

The counter

This cuts off outside views. Keep your outside relationships. A consensual version can be renegotiated and asks no proof of private acts. ◑

What they say or do

4 “How much did you earn this month?”, or a bigger ask timed to your payday or balance

The counter

Never share income, payday or balance. Keep the monthly cap independent of what is in the account. ◑

What they say or do

5 Lukewarm thanks for a send, with a hint that you can obviously afford more

The counter

A sales line, not information about what you can afford. Set the amount before the evening. ◑

> “Say no once, plainly. I would rather lose a send than keep a sub who cannot refuse me.

— Vivian

Pressure built into games and apps

Some pressure needs no person. A tool or a game can do it with a price, a timer or a streak. The table sets the pressure version of each design beside a safer one. Each row is a pattern seen in spending tools.

Same feature, two designs

	Pressure version	Safer version
Price	Hidden behind a multiplier, so the real total swings widely	A flat price, shown before the charge
Stop	Closing the window is the only stop, or the page locks until you pay	A stop that works in every state, at no cost
Odds	Near-misses, bets only the house can win, ties that go to the house	Odds shown, and a real prize for winning
Rewards	Streaks, a free daily spin, cards that fade unless you pull again	Rewards that do not punish a day away
Total	Not shown, or hidden behind an overlay	A running total always visible
Cap	None, or typed in the middle of a session	Set in advance and enforced outside the moment

If a payment system cannot be explained in a sentence, do not play it. A rule that sounds like a small tweak can carry a much larger house edge than people

expect, so read the odds before the first bet. Safe design shows what a tool does when it is built the other way.

A sub who says that the urge to be drained has come back needs a break. Selling into that moment, with a scene or a vow, is the opposite of a break.

Words that sell dependence

A promo line that names your compulsion as the reason to install a tool

What it does, and what to do

Ask what the tool does, what it collects and how it is stopped.

A caption that treats an emptying balance as the point of the game

What it does, and what to do

Persona voice with a real effect on the most vulnerable readers. Close the page and set a cap before you return.

A comparison that likens a new spend to a habit you already have

What it does, and what to do

It shrinks the feeling of a new spend. Decide the amount before you press anything.

An offer to help you quit, made by the person your spending pays

What it does, and what to do

She has a conflict of interest. Real help comes from someone the spending does not pay. See Where to get help.

Between doms, and on makers

Pressure also runs among doms, and between doms and the people who build for them.

Between doms and on makers

What they say or do

1 A story about your sub: “he is not really yours”

The counter

A sub is a person who chooses. Ask him, and ask the dom concerned. Never act on a rumour alone.

What they say or do

2 An offer to help with a sub who spends heavily, and later the split has changed without you

The counter

Do not share a heavy spender between doms: that is a red flag. Pause the money, point him to a cap and outside help, and agree any other arrangement in numbers and in writing before it starts.

What they say or do

3 A mentor’s trump card: “after all I did for you”, “then I am leaving”

The counter

Separate business from emotional debt. Ask for the reasoning, and refuse arrangements where seniority replaces explanation.

What they say or do

4 Praise and pet names in exchange for unlimited free work

The counter

Agree scope and payment first and keep the right to refuse. Otherwise it is free labour dressed as devotion.

What they say or do

5 “A builder must test his own tool with real money.”

The counter

A small amount, a test account or a screen recording. Never an open-ended spend to prove it works.

A senior dom offers help

A sub tells you he is spending heavily. A senior dom offers to help and suggests that the two of you share him, with a split of what he sends.

A Decline the share, pause the money part, and point him to a cap, a break and outside help

The right answer. A heavy spender is not an asset to divide. Both doms would be paid by his spending, so neither can be his safety net, and a split of such a sub between doms is a red flag.

B Ask for the roles, the split and who speaks to him in writing, then go ahead

Not this one. Writing it down makes the share tidy and no safer. He is still a person who spends heavily, and both of you still earn from it.

C Accept the help and sort out the split later

Not this one. Help can drift into a share of the sub without any agreement, and the money keeps flowing while nobody looks after him.

D Message the sub to say she is poaching

Not this one. It puts him in the middle of a dispute and it may prove unfair to her. Talk to her first.

Pressure from the sub side

Subs pressure doms too. Press reports that submissives also try to scam dominatrices. ◎ Reported The moves are plainer: haggling, “just this once”, a false claim to belong to another dom, a technical excuse at the moment more is asked, and vanishing after the first send. A dom who has written her rules down can point to them instead of arguing. ◑

Whatever a sub says about money, the dom does not rule on whether it is true. Any claim that money is short pauses the money part of the evening. ◑

Myth

Most subs who say they are broke are lying, so there is room to ask for more.

☆ Fact

Nobody can tell from outside, and the cost of being wrong falls on the sub. When a sub says money is short, the money part of the evening stops. ◑

Myth

If I do not take everything from an unstable sub, someone else will.

☆ Fact

That is the justification of exploitation. It moves the blame for harm onto the person who is hurt. ◑

Vivian's field notes

Pressure runs both ways, but not equally. I am paid when he sends, and I design the tools he uses. More of the responsibility sits with me, so my rules have to be written down before the first session and kept when it is inconvenient.

Write your rules down

1. State before the first session what you do not do: haggling, free previews, bargains.
2. Say plainly, ahead of time, when a sub must not send, and that you will stop the session and refuse the send if he does.
3. When a rule is tested, point to it. Do not argue.
4. When a sub says money is short, pause the money part of the evening.
5. When a sub is caught lying about another dom, block rather than spend energy on it. A firm no ends it, and stop messaging when someone asks.

Saying no

Refuse once, calmly

1. Say the boundary once, in one sentence.
2. Do not explain, justify or prove it.
3. Wait before answering anything that carries a deadline.
4. If the pressure continues after the no, that is the answer. Leave, block, keep the messages and tell one person you trust.

Name the lever

Question 1 of 3

A dom thanks you for a send in a lukewarm way and hints that you can obviously afford more. What is it?

- ◯ Information about what you can afford
- ◯ A sales line that tries to raise the amount
- ◯ A fair review of your send

Answer. A sales line that tries to raise the amount. The line praises and shames in one breath. Set the amount before the evening.

Question 2 of 3

A dom says she respects your limits, then asks for a small test just past them. What do you do?

- ◯ Treat the limit as softened
- ◯ Take the respect and ignore the next sentence
- ◯ Explain the limit again at length

Answer. Take the respect and ignore the next sentence. Words about limits do not mean the nudge has stopped.

Question 3 of 3

A dom gives permission but says she will just be sad. What is the cost?

- ◯ A permission that arrives with guilt attached
- ◯ None, because she said yes
- ◯ A reward for honesty

Answer. A permission that arrives with guilt attached. Ask for a plain yes or no, and talk about the need underneath.

When the spending stops being a game

Some signs say that a sub is deep in compulsion: spending hundreds in one day, paying several doms at once, weeks of chatting without calming down, deleting chats after each send. ◑ Hiding the spending from a partner is a risk factor, and one author compares some cases to problem gambling. ◎ Reported Compulsion needs slower handling, not extra asks. ◑

A dom who earns from a sub cannot be his safety net. She can stop, listen, ask for nothing more and point outward. Tapering his spending herself or moving him to a better dom is a conflict of interest, not help. ◑ In a crisis, the help is outside: emergency services, a helpline, a person physically near. Go to The spiral, Breaks that hold, When a sub is in trouble and Where to get help.

Remember it

1. Pressure takes away time, choice or privacy. Name the move and the pressure loses its work.
2. Nothing is owed unless you agreed to it in advance.
3. Words about respect do not mean the nudge has stopped.
4. A design can pressure you without a person: look for hidden totals, streaks and no stop.
5. Subs pressure doms too, and written rules answer it. The dom carries more of the responsibility.
6. When the spending stops being a game, the help comes from someone it does not pay.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.

Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.
Unverified	Plausible, not proven yet.

1 Pressure takes away time, choice or privacy.

Vivian's field notes

2 Nearly every move below does one of the three, and it works best on a person who is aroused, tired, ashamed or attached.

Vivian's field notes

3 A scene built on those states is a scene where they are normal, which is why the same moves work here so well.

Vivian's field notes

4 A former participant describes men who sold cars, took on debt and worked second jobs.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

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6 A writer calls the threat of exposure a common punishment from financial doms.

Reported

Diary of a Financial Dominatrix, part one (https://www.theskinny.co.uk/sexuality/deviance/diary-of-a-financial-dominatrix-part-one)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20200805021033/https://www.theskinny.co.uk/sexuality/deviance/diary-of-a-financial-dominatrix-part-one)

Accessed 3 November 2026

7 A study notes that some findommes keep humiliation lists of clients who fail to give enough tribute.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

8 Humiliation, ownership and rigged bets can be fantasies that adults choose. The same words become pressure when the sub did not choose them, cannot see the cost or has no way to stop. The test I use is whether the performance is steering the spending. A sub who gave in was under pressure built to work, and nothing here is a verdict on him.

◑ Vivian's field notes

9 Real play survives the wait.

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10 A third answer always exists: reply tomorrow.

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11 You can walk away.

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12 Say it once, then stop discussing it.

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13 Words about limits do not mean the nudge has stopped.

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14 Ask what is wanted and slow down.

◑ Vivian's field notes

15 A healthy bond survives a boundary.

Vivian's field notes

16 Ask for a plain yes or no and talk about the need underneath.

Vivian's field notes

17 Keep warmth that does not.

Vivian's field notes

18 Notice it.

Vivian's field notes

19 See Case files.

Vivian's field notes

20 A wish for privacy needs no proof.

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21 A consensual version can be renegotiated and asks no proof of private acts.

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22 Keep the monthly cap independent of what is in the account.

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23 Set the amount before the evening.

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24 Say no once, plainly. I would rather lose a send than keep a sub who cannot refuse me.

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25 Each row is a pattern seen in spending tools.

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26 If a payment system cannot be explained in a sentence, do not play it.

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27 A rule that sounds like a small tweak can carry a much larger house edge than people expect, so read the odds before the first bet.

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28 Selling into that moment, with a scene or a vow, is the opposite of a break.

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29 Never act on a rumour alone.

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30 Pause the money, point him to a cap and outside help, and agree any other arrangement in numbers and in writing before it starts.

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31 Ask for the reasoning, and refuse arrangements where seniority replaces explanation.

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32 Otherwise it is free labour dressed as devotion.

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33 Never an open-ended spend to prove it works.

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34 Press reports that submissives also try to scam dominatrices.

Reported

Financial Domination Has a Scamming Problem (https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260827104045/https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem/)

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42 Hiding the spending from a partner is a risk factor, and one author compares some cases to problem gambling.

Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

43 Compulsion needs slower handling, not extra asks.

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44 She can stop, listen, ask for nothing more and point outward.

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45 Tapering his spending herself or moving him to a better dom is a conflict of interest, not help.

Vivian's field notes

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

Find a helpline →

Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.